

P E R C E P T I O N

EVERY LENS IS
DIFFERENT



YOU SEE YOUR DAUGHTER THROUGH YOUR LENS. HER COACH SEES HER THROUGH A DIFFERENT ONE. BOTH ARE REAL.



THE SERIES

FIVE LESSONS. ONE PLAYER.

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Every Lens Is Different

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Your Daughter Performs Through Her Lens

Coming up.

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The Home Conversation She Can Hear

Coming up.

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What's Actually In Your Control

Coming up.

05

Responding vs. Reacting to Perception

Coming up.

HEAR THIS ONCE

THE WAY YOU SEE YOUR
DAUGHTER'S PERFORMANCE IS NOT
THE SAME AS HOW HER COACH SEES
IT AND NEITHER VIEW IS WRONG.

Perception is built from experience, context, and stage of life. What looks like a missed opportunity from the stands looks like a decision made under tactical pressure from the bench. Both observations can be true simultaneously.

— LEVERY LENS IS BUILT FROM DIFFERENT DATA · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE LENS MODEL

**YOU CANNOT CHANGE SOMEONE
ELSE'S LENS. YOU CAN ONLY
CONTROL WHAT YOU PUT IN
FRONT OF IT.**

→ Your lens: your history, your investment, your daughter's potential as you see it

→ The coach's lens: the team system, the tactical read, the competitive context

→ Your daughter's lens: her experience, her confidence, her read of the moment

— THREE PEOPLE CAN WATCH THE SAME PLAY AND ALL THREE ARE RIGHT.

05 · THE BREAKDOWN

THE PAJAMA STORY

TWO OBSERVERS

Two people drive past the same group of women in pajamas. One sees a bridal party. One sees teachers.

BOTH RIGHT

Both interpretations are grounded in real experience — neither person is lying or wrong.

THE COURT

The same moment on the court produces three different interpretations: parent, coach, athlete. All valid.



NAVIGATING MULTIPLE LENSES

IN PRACTICE

Before confronting a coach's decision, ask: 'What might they be seeing that I'm not?'

WATCH FOR

Moments where you interpret a coach decision through only your lens and then act on it.

THE SHIFT

From 'the coach is wrong' to 'the coach sees something different — what is it?'



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

YOU CANNOT CHANGE SOMEONE
ELSE'S LENS. YOU CAN ONLY CONTROL
HOW YOU SHOW UP IN FRONT OF IT.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— THE LENS LAW

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, PRACTICE THE LENS QUESTION.

- ✓ After the next game, identify one coaching decision you disagreed with
- ✓ Ask: 'What might the coach have seen from her position that I couldn't from mine?'
- ✓ Hold both interpretations simultaneously don't resolve them into one right answer
- ✓ Notice how this shifts your response to the coach



PERCEPTION

YOUR DAUGHTER
PERFORMS THROUGH HER
LENS

02

SHE PLAYS DIFFERENTLY IN FRONT OF YOU THAN IN FRONT OF HER COACH. THIS IS NOT A PROBLEM.

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HEAR THIS ONCE

YOUR ATHLETE DOES NOT PERFORM
THE SAME WAY IN FRONT OF YOU AS
SHE DOES IN FRONT OF ANYONE
ELSE AND SHE NEVER WILL.

The parent relationship is the most emotionally loaded relationship in an athlete's life. That means more emotional noise positive and negative in every moment she knows you are watching.

— YOUR PRESENCE CHANGES HER PERFORMANCE · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE PARENT EFFECT

YOU ARE NOT JUST WATCHING
HER PLAY. YOU ARE PART OF THE
PERFORMANCE ENVIRONMENT
WHETHER YOU MEAN TO BE OR
NOT.

- She is always tracking your reaction: your face, your body, your stillness or motion
- The emotional weight of your approval or disapproval is heavier than anyone else's
- Your presence is an input manage it with the same intention you bring to her development

— YOUR FACE IS A SCOREBOARD SHE CHECKS THROUGHOUT EVERY GAME.

05 · THE BREAKDOWN

THE EMOTIONAL LOAD

THE CHECK

Athletes whose parents are in the stands will find them in the crowd multiple times per match.

THE READ

In a fraction of a second, she reads your body language and interprets it. Frown? She knows.

THE COST

Every emotional load she carries from the stands is energy not available for the next play.



MANAGING YOUR PRESENCE

IN PRACTICE

Neutral face, still body, and quiet energy during the match is one of the best gifts you can give her.

WATCH FOR

The moments you visibly react and then watch whether she finds you right after.

THE SHIFT

From spectating emotionally to managing your presence as a deliberate input to her performance.



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS · COME BACK TO IT

YOUR PRESENCE AT HER GAMES IS
NOT PASSIVE. IT IS AN ACTIVE INPUT
TO HER PERFORMANCE. MANAGE IT
ACCORDINGLY.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— THE PRESENCE LAW

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, PRACTICE NEUTRAL PRESENCE.

- ✓ At the next match, track how many times she looks at you in the stands
- ✓ Commit to a neutral face and still body for one full set
- ✓ After the match, ask: 'Did you feel my energy from the stands today?'
- ✓ Notice whether her check-ins with you increase or decrease under neutral presence



PERCEPTION

THE HOME CONVERSATION
SHE CAN HEAR

03

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT VOLLEYBALL AT HOME — EVEN WHEN YOU THINK SHE’S NOT LISTENING — IS SHAPING HER LENS.



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HEAR THIS ONCE

PARENTS TALK ABOUT THE COACH,
THE TEAM, THE SYSTEM IN FRONT
OF THEIR ATHLETES AND WONDER
WHY THEIR ATHLETES DON'T TRUST
THE PROCESS.

You are always being overheard. And your narrative about the coach, the team, or her performance is becoming part of her operating system — whether you intend it to or not.

— THE HOME CONVERSATION IS A CURRICULUM · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE AMBIENT CURRICULUM

WHAT YOU SAY AROUND YOUR
DAUGHTER ABOUT VOLLEYBALL IS
ONE OF THE MOST POWERFUL
LESSONS SHE IS RECEIVING.

→ She is building her lens from your commentary even the offhand remarks

→ Criticism of the coach at home creates divided loyalty on the court

→ Trust in the system at home creates the mental clarity to perform in it

— THE CONVERSATIONS YOU HAVE ABOUT VOLLEYBALL ARE PART OF HER COACHING.

THE SIGNAL

DIRECT SIGNAL

Statements made to her face: 'The coach doesn't see what you're capable of.' She hears: distrust the coach.

AMBIENT SIGNAL

Conversations in the kitchen: 'I don't know what that coach is thinking.' She hears it from another room.

THE EFFECT

An athlete whose parents undermine the coach is an athlete performing with a divided nervous system.



AUDITING THE HOME CURRICULUM

IN PRACTICE

For one week, notice every statement you make about the coach within earshot of your athlete.

WATCH FOR

Statements that begin with 'I don't know why the coach...' — those are the ones to audit.

THE SHIFT

From processing your frustration through your athlete to processing it outside of her hearing.



SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

SHE IS ALWAYS LISTENING. MAKE
SURE WHAT SHE IS HEARING IS
BUILDING HER, NOT DIVIDING HER.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— THE CURRICULUM LAW

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, AUDIT THE HOME CURRICULUM FOR ONE WEEK.

- ✓ Notice every volleyball comment you make at home positive or critical
- ✓ Flag any that could divide her loyalty to the coach or team
- ✓ Replace one critical comment with a process question: 'What did you learn at practice?'
- ✓ Notice how the home conversation shifts when you shift it



PERCEPTION

WHAT'S ACTUALLY
IN YOUR CONTROL



YOU CAN'T CHANGE THE COACH'S LENS. FOCUS ON WHAT YOU CAN CHANGE.



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HEAR THIS ONCE

MOST PARENT ENERGY GOES
TOWARD TRYING TO INFLUENCE
THINGS OUTSIDE OF THEIR CONTROL
PLAYING TIME, TEAM DECISIONS,
COACHING STYLE.

The coach's lens, the team's decisions, the system's priorities these are largely outside your control. Where you place your energy determines whether you feel empowered or exhausted by this season.

THE CONTROL MAP

EVERY HOUR YOU SPEND ON WHAT
YOU CAN'T CONTROL IS AN HOUR
NOT SPENT ON WHAT YOU CAN.

→ What you can control: your presence, your language, your athlete's home environment

→ What you cannot control: playing time, coaching decisions, team dynamics

→ Where you place your energy tells your athlete what you believe matters most

— FOCUS ON YOUR INPUTS. LET GO OF THE OUTPUTS.

05 · THE BREAKDOWN

THE ENERGY AUDIT

HIGH CONTROL

Your attitude, your language, your presence, your relationship with your daughter after hard moments.

LOW CONTROL

Coaching decisions, lineup, who plays where, team selection, other players' behavior.

THE LEAK

Every conversation, text, or mental energy spent on low-control items is a leak from what matters.



RECLAIMING ENERGY

IN PRACTICE

This week, catch yourself spending energy on a low-control item and redirect it.

WATCH FOR

The parent group chat often the highest-volume low-control energy drain.

THE SHIFT

From trying to influence the system to building your athlete for whatever the system presents.



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

YOU HAVE A FINITE AMOUNT OF
ENERGY THIS SEASON. SPEND IT
WHERE IT ACTUALLY MOVES THE
NEEDLE.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— THE ENERGY LAW

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, COMPLETE THE ENERGY AUDIT.

✓ List everything you've spent emotional energy on in the last two weeks regarding volleyball

✓ Categorize each item: high control or low control

✓ Choose one low-control item to stop spending energy on

✓ Redirect that energy to one high-control input this week



PERCEPTION

RESPONDING VS.
REACTING TO PERCEPTION

OS

HOW YOU RESPOND TO A COACHING DECISION BECOMES THE LESSON YOUR ATHLETE REMEMBERS.



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HEAR THIS ONCE

THE COACHING DECISION IS NOT
THE MOST IMPORTANT MOMENT.
YOUR RESPONSE TO IT IS.

YOUR ATHLETE IS WATCHING HOW YOU HANDLE DISAGREEMENT, DISAPPOINTMENT, AND INJUSTICE. YOUR RESPONSE TO THE COACH'S LENS BECOMES ONE OF THE MOST POWERFUL LESSONS SHE WILL CARRY OUT OF THIS SPORT.

— YOUR RESPONSE IS THE LESSON · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE RESPONSE MODEL

THE DECISION WAS MADE. THE
LESSON IS WHAT HAPPENS NEXT
AND YOU ARE TEACHING IT.

- React: emotion first, words before thought, model of reactivity
- Respond: pause, process, choose — model of emotional regulation
- The lesson: whichever you model is what she practices when pressure hits her

— SHE DOESN'T REMEMBER THE DECISION. SHE REMEMBERS HOW YOU HANDLED IT.

REACT VS. RESPOND

REACT

Immediate, emotional, unfiltered releases the parent's tension and increases the athlete's.

RESPOND

Deliberate, regulated, modeled costs the parent effort and deposits confidence into the athlete.

THE MODELING WINDOW

Every difficult moment at a volleyball tournament is a live lesson in emotional management.



THE PAUSE PRACTICE

IN PRACTICE

Before responding to a coaching decision you disagree with, pause for one breath and one question: 'What do I want to model here?'



WATCH FOR

Your first instinct is it reaction or response? Notice the pattern over several games.

THE SHIFT

From releasing your emotional tension in the moment to holding it long enough to choose your response.



SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

Every moment you choose response over reaction, you are teaching your athlete the most important skill in sport and in life.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— THE MODEL LAW

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, PRACTICE THE PAUSE BEFORE RESPONDING.

✓ At the next match, commit to one breath before any spoken reaction to a coaching decision

✓ Ask: 'What do I want to model here?' before you speak

✓ After the match, tell your athlete about one moment where you chose response

✓ Make it visible modeling is most powerful when it's named